

# INFLUENCES, METHODOLOGY & EXPERTISE

## Comprehensive Knowledge & Approach Documentation

### Influences & Methodology

My methodology is forged from an unusual convergence: civil engineering precision, humanitarian field experience in extreme conditions, and five years of hard-won lessons building coaching businesses. Where most coaches draw from books and mentors, my approach is grounded in building homes for tsunami survivors, managing post-conflict reconstruction under severe constraints, and the repeated failures that taught me what actually works versus what sounds good in theory.

### Key Influences

#### People

**My Mother:** The primary influence on my drive and identity. She pushed me to be my best in all things, creating both ambition and an inner child wound around proving I'm 'enough.' Her belief in me became both fuel and burden—I spent decades achieving to show her (and myself) I could become what she thought I should be. The wound this created—constantly seeking external validation through achievement—shapes how I now help coaches recognize when they're building businesses to prove something rather than to serve.

**Humanitarian Colleagues & Communities:** Ten years working alongside displaced families in Gaza, Banda Aceh, and Serbia taught me what resilience actually looks like. Not from books, but from watching communities rebuild after catastrophic loss. These people showed me that adversity is where character is formed, that service should have no caveats, and that you must meet people where they are, not where you want them to be. They also showed me the contrast between authentic service and exploitation—some showed up selflessly while others used tragedy for self-promotion.

#### Books & Resources

***Think and Grow Rich by Napoleon Hill:*** Fundamentally shaped my understanding that our thoughts about becoming better determine everything. Hill's core premise—that you become what you think about—resonates with my experience. However, my application differs from most: I've witnessed how people have stopped thinking for themselves, delegating their thinking to 'higher powers' (gurus, coaches, algorithms). True freedom comes from reprogramming your subconscious toward an abundant mindset while thinking critically about your own path rather than blindly following someone else's blueprint.

#### Methodologies & Frameworks

**Civil Engineering & Project Management Principles:** My formal training provides the structural foundation for how I approach business building. Engineering teaches you to test before building infrastructure, to work with measurable outcomes, to break complex projects into phases, and to deliver under constraints. I apply this systematically: validate offers quickly with low-ticket tests before building full programs, use data to guide decisions (Facebook ads give binary feedback), and approach business building as iterative project management rather than hoping and praying.

**Inner Child Healing & Shadow Work:** Doing deep work around my inner child wounds revealed that most coaching business failures aren't strategic—they're psychological. The wound of 'not being enough,' the need for external validation, the fear of being seen—these sabotage every business until healed. This work taught me that personal development and business growth cannot be separated. You can't sustainably grow a business beyond your own inner development.

### **Formative Experiences**

**Growing Up During The Troubles (Belfast, Northern Ireland):** Witnessing a guerrilla war between UK forces and paramilitaries taught me early lessons about the curse of intolerance and the importance of moral clarity around right and wrong. The conflict created both danger and, paradoxically, safety—the thing that kept outsiders away created a protected space to grow. This shaped my values around fairness and my intolerance for exploitation and false promises in business.

**Leading Save the Children's Tsunami Response (Banda Aceh, 2004):** As head of the rehousing program after a disaster that killed over 200,000 people, I learned about delivering under impossible constraints. Building culturally sensitive homes with severe logistical challenges taught me that real service means meeting people's actual needs, not imposing your vision. It also taught me the difference between those who serve and those who exploit—some used the tragedy for grand standing. This distinction now informs how I differentiate authentic coaching from predatory marketing.

**Quitting Corporate Job (Failed Experiment):** The expensive lesson of trying to build a business from desperation. When survival depends on making sales, your energy shifts—you become focused on getting paid rather than genuinely serving. The desperation corrupted everything. I went back to corporate understanding that building from a position of abundance (keeping the safety net) allows you to maintain integrity and serve authentically. This now informs my counter-cultural advice: don't quit your job until you have something tested and viable.

**Five Years of Business Failures (Affiliate Marketing, Coaching):** Trying multiple business models that looked good on paper but felt misaligned taught me the core principle: you can't grow into pain. Affiliate marketing failed because selling others' products didn't align with my value of authentic service. Transformation coaching was draining because clients underestimated the consistency required and I was taking people on a journey I hadn't completed myself. These failures weren't wasted time—they taught me that alignment matters more than tactics, and that most coaches are building businesses they'll eventually hate because they're following someone else's blueprint.

## Unique Methodology

### Core Principles

- **Show What I Teach, Teach What I Show:** I only teach what I've tested, even if that means admitting I'm still building. No theoretical frameworks or borrowed strategies presented as proven. If I haven't done it, I don't teach it.
- **You Can't Grow Into Pain:** The foundational principle underlying everything. If showing up in your business feels like forcing yourself into clothes that don't fit, you will eventually quit. Human beings cannot sustain misalignment. This principle guides how I help coaches identify whether they're building something they can actually sustain.
- **Flow and Ease Over Force:** An aligned business should feel like flow, not constant force. While resilience and consistency are required, there's a difference between pushing through strategic discomfort and grinding against fundamental misalignment.
- **Service Without Caveats:** Learned from humanitarian work. Give service freely without expectation of return. In coaching, this means genuine help first, sales second. No manipulation, no exploitation of desperation.
- **Test, Validate, Build:** Engineering approach applied to business. Don't build entire infrastructure before knowing if it works. Start with low-ticket validation (someone who pays \$7 has skin in the game), prove market demand, then scale from proven ground.
- **Meet People Where They Are:** From humanitarian field work. Coaches are at different levels and abilities. You can't impose transformation on people who aren't ready. Build offers that match where people actually are, not where you want them to be.
- **Inner Work = Outer Work:** Personal development and business growth cannot be separated. Your business will only grow as much as you've grown. Most business problems are actually psychological problems—fear of being seen, fear of failure, fear of success, the need to prove you're enough.

### Distinctive Methodological Elements

- **Low-Ticket Validation Funnel:** Unlike coaches who push free lead magnets or jump straight to high-ticket, I use \$7-27 offers as qualifying mechanism. Someone who pays even \$7 has raised their hand that they actually want to solve a problem, not just collect free content. This creates a self-liquidating funnel that generates leads while validating market demand, then naturally ascends buyers to medium and high-ticket offers.
- **Zone of Genius Extraction Process:** Deep dive interview combined with AI prompts to help coaches identify their unique differentiator. Most coaches try to solve too many problems for too many people. I help them focus on the ONE burning problem their unique background positions them to solve better than anyone else. The magic happens in packaging that difference into a sellable offer.
- **Counter-Cultural Positioning on Job Security:** I actively advise coaches NOT to quit their 9-to-5 until they have a tested, viable business. This contradicts 90% of the coaching industry but reflects hard-won wisdom: desperate energy destroys everything. Building from abundance (keeping the safety net) allows authentic service and maintains integrity.

- **Alignment Audit Before Strategy:** Before diving into tactics, I help coaches assess whether their current business model is actually aligned with who they are. Most failures stem from building the wrong business, not executing poorly. If you're building a business you fundamentally can't grow into, no amount of strategy will save you.
- **Asset-Based Business Design:** Focus on building functional assets (DFY funnels, AI prompts, paid communities with tiered access) rather than just selling time. This reflects my understanding that time freedom matters more than any other metric—coaches need systems that run without them being the bottleneck.

### **How My Approach Differs**

Most coaches in my space promise quick wins and teach tactics divorced from psychology. They position themselves as having 'arrived' and sell the dream of quitting your job in 90 days. They focus on posting more content, building massive audiences, and hoping clients materialize.

My approach acknowledges that building takes longer than gurus admit, that alignment matters more than tactics, and that most coaching businesses fail because of psychological barriers, not strategic ones. I teach sustainable building over overnight success, validation before infrastructure, and inner work concurrent with outer work.

I differentiate by being transparent about still being in the arena myself—still building, still in corporate, still working toward my goals. This isn't a weakness; it's my greatest strength with coaches who are 2-5 years in, investment-deep, wondering if they should quit. I understand exactly what they're going through because I'm there with them.

### **Evolution Over Time**

My methodology has evolved from seeking the 'magic bullet' to understanding that alignment is everything. Early on, I chased tactics and strategies, trying to fit into other coaches' blueprints. Now I understand that the work is helping coaches think for themselves, find what's true to them, and build something they can actually sustain. The shift is from 'here's the proven system' to 'here's how to discover what will work for you specifically.' This evolution reflects my own journey from external validation to internal alignment—and that's the transformation I now help others achieve.

## **Knowledge & Expertise Areas**

### **1. Civil Engineering & Project Management**

Formal training and extensive experience managing infrastructure projects of all sizes. Brings systematic thinking, process orientation, and engineering precision to business building. This technical foundation informs my test-validate-build approach and focus on measurable outcomes.

#### **Specific Skills:**

- Breaking complex projects into manageable phases with clear deliverables

- Working with measurable outcomes and data-driven decision making
- Delivering results under severe constraints (time, budget, resources)
- Systematic problem-solving and iterative development
- Quality control and validation before scaling

**Credibility Markers:** Formal civil engineering degree and project management certification. Managed both small and large infrastructure projects. This technical background differentiates me in a coaching space dominated by marketers with no systematic training.

## 2. International Development & Humanitarian Leadership

Ten years leading post-conflict and post-disaster reconstruction in extreme conditions. Deep expertise in delivering transformational outcomes under severe constraints while maintaining cultural sensitivity and authentic service orientation. This experience provides unassailable authority on resilience, authentic service, and what actually matters.

### Specific Skills:

- Leading teams in high-stakes, resource-constrained environments
- Cross-cultural communication and culturally sensitive program design
- Meeting people where they are with appropriate, context-specific solutions
- Distinguishing authentic service from exploitation and grand standing
- Managing complex stakeholder relationships in crisis situations

**Credibility Markers:** Head of Save the Children's rehousing program in Banda Aceh post-2004 tsunami. Worked in Gaza Strip (UNRWA), southern Serbia on post-conflict reconstruction. Ten years field experience in some of the world's most challenging environments. This background provides perspective on adversity, resilience, and authentic service that no business course can teach.

## 3. Low-Ticket to High-Ticket Funnel Strategy

Validated approach for moving cold traffic to motivated buyers through strategic low-ticket offers that test market demand before building full programs. Creates self-liquidating funnels that generate leads while proving viability, then naturally ascends buyers to premium offers. Engineering approach applied to marketing.

### Specific Skills:

- Designing \$7-27 offers that solve one burning problem and qualify buyers
- Building self-liquidating funnels that generate leads profitably
- Creating natural ascension pathways from low to medium to high-ticket
- Using paid traffic (Facebook ads) for rapid validation feedback
- Scaling validated offers while maintaining quality and alignment

**Credibility Markers:** Successfully validated own low-ticket funnel with 7 sales and order bumps, proving the model works. Currently building scalable system with tiered community access and high-ticket programs. Five years of testing multiple approaches provides perspective on what works versus what sounds good in theory.

## 4. Zone of Genius Extraction & Offer Positioning

Systematic process for helping coaches identify their unique differentiator and package it into compelling, sellable offers. Combines deep-dive interviews, AI-assisted analysis, and rapid market validation to clarify messaging and positioning. Focuses on solving ONE core problem rather than trying to help everyone with everything.

**Specific Skills:**

- Conducting deep-dive interviews to uncover unique expertise and unfair advantages
- Using AI prompts to extract and articulate zone of genius
- Identifying the ONE burning problem a coach is uniquely positioned to solve
- Packaging expertise into clear, compelling offers that demonstrate transformation
- Testing offers quickly to validate market demand before full build-out

**Credibility Markers:** Worked with 50+ coaches helping them identify unfair advantages and build sellable offers. Developed proprietary extraction frameworks and AI prompt sequences. Own journey of trying multiple offers provides firsthand understanding of why most coaching offers fail (too broad, trying to solve too many problems).

## 5. Business Alignment & Sustainability Coaching

Deep expertise in helping coaches build businesses they can actually sustain because they're aligned with who they authentically are. Five years of testing multiple business models provides hard-won wisdom about identifying misalignment and avoiding the trap of building businesses you'll eventually hate. Core differentiator in a market focused on tactics over psychology.

**Specific Skills:**

- Conducting alignment audits before strategy implementation
- Identifying when coaches are building to prove something vs. to serve
- Recognizing early signs of misalignment (dread, resistance, exhaustion beyond normal startup challenges)
- Helping coaches pivot from misaligned models to sustainable approaches
- Teaching the principle 'you can't grow into pain' as foundation for all decisions

**Credibility Markers:** Five years personal experience building misaligned businesses (affiliate marketing, transformation coaching) before finding alignment. This journey provides authentic authority on recognizing misalignment that coaches with quick success cannot offer. Can speak to the long game with credibility earned through struggle.

## 6. Resilience Psychology & Long-Term Thinking

Understanding that most entrepreneurs underestimate how long it takes to build aligned businesses. Expertise in helping coaches develop the psychological resilience required for sustainable success rather than promising quick wins.

Teaches that adversity is where character is formed, drawing from both humanitarian field experience and personal business journey.

**Specific Skills:**

- Normalizing the 3-5 year timeline for building sustainable businesses
- Helping coaches reframe 'failure' as necessary learning and iteration
- Teaching consistency and showing up despite setbacks
- Counter-cultural positioning: keep your job, build sustainably, no false urgency
- Distinguishing between strategic discomfort (grow through it) and misalignment (pivot away)

**Credibility Markers:** Ten years humanitarian work in extreme conditions provides unassailable authority on true resilience. Five years building own business with repeated setbacks demonstrates lived experience of long-term commitment. Still building openly rather than claiming to have 'arrived' creates authentic resonance with coaches in the struggle.

## 7. Inner Work Integration & Mindset Transformation

Understanding that personal development and business growth cannot be separated. Expertise in helping coaches recognize and heal the psychological wounds (fear of being seen, fear of failure, need to prove worth) that sabotage business success. Teaches that inner child healing and abundance mindset work must be concurrent with business building.

**Specific Skills:**

- Identifying when business problems are actually psychological barriers
- Normalizing fear (of being seen, of failure, of success, of asking people to buy)
- Helping coaches recognize when they're building to prove something vs. to serve
- Teaching abundance mindset and reprogramming limiting beliefs
- Integrating inner child healing with business strategy

**Credibility Markers:** Personal journey of deep inner child work around 'not being enough' wound provides authentic understanding. Recognition that own business struggles stemmed from psychological barriers, not strategic failures, creates credibility in teaching this integration. Influenced by Think and Grow Rich but evolved beyond surface-level positive thinking to deep subconscious reprogramming.

## 8. Facebook Ads & Paid Traffic Strategy

Experience with paid acquisition strategies that provide rapid, binary validation on offer viability. Understands the engineering principle of measurable, testable systems applied to marketing. Focus on data-driven decision making rather than hope-based organic strategies that take years to validate.

**Specific Skills:**

- Creating Facebook ad campaigns for low-ticket offer validation
- Reading data and benchmarks for premium validation offers

- Using paid traffic for rapid feedback loops (vs. waiting months for organic growth)
- Understanding Facebook ad account restrictions and compliance for coaching businesses
- Scaling strategies that maintain customer quality while growing revenue

**Credibility Markers:** Successfully validated own low-ticket offer through paid traffic. Developed comprehensive guides on Facebook ad compliance and data reading for coaches. Understands that paid traffic gives binary feedback quickly—you know pretty fast if it's going to work, unlike organic strategies that leave you guessing for months.

## Unique Intersections of Expertise

What sets my expertise apart isn't any single domain but the unique convergence of multiple fields that rarely intersect:

- **Engineering Precision + Humanitarian Service:** The systematic approach of engineering combined with the authentic service orientation of humanitarian work creates a methodology that's both strategic and genuinely helpful. Most coaches have one or the other, not both.
- **Extreme Resilience + Current Struggle:** Authority from leading teams through catastrophic disasters combined with transparency about still building creates unique positioning. I understand both true adversity and the specific challenges of building a coaching business.
- **Tactical Expertise + Psychological Depth:** Most coaches teach either tactics (funnels, ads, offers) or mindset work (inner child, abundance). The integration of both—understanding that business problems are often psychological problems—differentiates my approach completely.
- **Counter-Cultural Wisdom + Market Understanding:** The courage to teach opposite of what most coaches preach (keep your job, take longer than gurus admit, alignment over tactics) combined with understanding of market dynamics and what actually converts.

This convergence creates a position in the market that cannot be easily replicated: the humanitarian-turned-engineer-turned-coach who's building alongside his clients, teaching sustainable success over quick wins, and integrating deep inner work with strategic execution.

## Information Gaps & Enhancement Opportunities

**Potential areas for additional detail:**

- **Specific methodologies or frameworks from civil engineering training:** Could add more detail about specific project management frameworks (Agile, Waterfall, etc.) if relevant to coaching approach.
- **Additional books or resources beyond Think and Grow Rich:** While Think and Grow Rich was mentioned, there may be other influential books on mindset, business, or personal development worth documenting.
- **Specific inner child healing modalities:** Could document specific therapeutic approaches or practitioners that influenced the inner work journey.

- **Quantitative results from working with 50+ coaches:** Could add specific success metrics, testimonials, or case studies if available.
- **Details on AI prompt engineering expertise:** Could elaborate on specific AI tools, prompt frameworks, or methodologies used in zone of genius extraction.

**Evolution timeline:** Could add more specific dates/timeline of when each business model was tried and pivoted from within the 5-year journey.